

Lighting & Phong Reflection Model – Lecture Notes

■ 1. FUNDAMENTALS OF LIGHTING

- Illumination: Energy transport from light sources to surfaces.
- Local Illumination – Depends on direct light.
- Global Illumination – Includes reflection/refraction.
- Lighting Model: Determines surface color or brightness based on lighting.

■ 2. TYPES OF LIGHT SOURCES

- Ambient Light: No direction; background light.
- Diffuse Light: Scattered reflection; follows Lambert's cosine law.
- Specular Light: Mirror-like reflection; depends on viewer.

Formula: Total Illumination = Ambient + Diffuse + Specular

■ 3. PHONG REFLECTION MODEL

$$I = I_a + I_p [k_d \max(L \cdot N, 0) + k_s \max(R \cdot V, 0)^n]$$

Where:

- I = total light intensity at point
- I_a = ambient intensity, I_p = point light intensity
- k_a , k_d , k_s = ambient, diffuse, specular coefficients
- L = Light vector, N = Normal, R = Reflected ray, V = View vector
- n = shininess exponent

■ 4. COMPONENTS EXPLAINED

- Ambient Reflection:
 - Uniform light, simulates global bounce.
 - Not viewer or angle dependent.
 - $I_{amb} = I_a k_a$
- Diffuse Reflection (Lambertian):
 - Based on angle between L and N
 - $I_{diff} = I_p * k_d * \max(0, L \cdot N)$
- Specular Reflection:
 - Depends on angle between R and V
 - $I_{spec} = I_p * k_s * \max(0, R \cdot V)^n$

Blinn-Phong variation:

Replace $R \cdot V$ with $N \cdot H$ where H = half vector between L and V .

■ 5. SPOTLIGHT

- Emits light in a conical region.
- Requires direction, cutoff angle θ , and falloff function.
- Intensity drops outside cutoff.